ShopSense Refund Policy

Effective 2026-01-01. Governs how refunds are calculated, approved, and issued once a return or refund request is accepted.

RF-1 Refund Amount

RF-1.1 Standard Refund

The customer receives the full item price paid, excluding the original shipping fee -- unless the return reason is RP-1.3 (defective or wrong item), in which case shipping is also refunded.

RF-1.2 Partial Refunds

If an item is returned without original packaging or with visible wear not disclosed at the time of the return request, ShopSense may deduct up to 20% as a restocking adjustment, subject to the RF-3 approval tiers below.

RF-2 Refund Timing

Refund Method Processing Time After Item Received
Original payment method (card) 5-7 business days
UPI / wallet 2-3 business days
Store credit Instant
Cash on Delivery orders (bank transfer) 7-10 business days

Refund timing is measured from when the returned item passes warehouse quality check. Warehouse QC itself must complete within 48 hours of receipt -- internal SLA code SLA-48.

RF-3 Approval Tiers

Refunds are approved automatically or escalated based on amount:

Refund Amount (INR) Approval Tier
Below 2,000 Auto-approved, no manual review
2,000 to 9,999 Manager review required
10,000 and above Executive review required

A customer account flagged for return abuse (3 or more high-value returns of INR 5,000+ within 90 days; definition in fraud_prevention.md FP-1) is routed to manual review regardless of amount -- see escalation code ESC-ABUSE in the Escalation SOP. Who may approve each tier, and AI-agent limits, are in refund_authorisation_matrix.md RA-1.

RF-4 Refund Request Without a Return

RF-4.1 Order Never Arrived

If tracking shows no movement for 10 days past the estimated delivery date, the customer may request a full refund without returning anything, since nothing was received. See also Shipping Policy section SP-4.1 (lost shipments, escalation code ESC-LOST).

RF-4.2 Duplicate Charge

A duplicate charge for the same order is refunded in full within 3 business days once confirmed by finance, independent of the RF-3 approval tiers above.

RF-5 Related Policies

See the Return Policy (document: return_policy.md) for return windows and eligibility, and the Shipping Policy (document: shipping_policy.md) for the delivery SLAs referenced in RF-4.1.